

Lumen Sales Playbook: Water Utilities

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1. Why water utilities

Water utilities are the largest single segment for the Lumen range, accounting for roughly 45% of Lumen unit volume in FY2024/25. The typical buyer is a regional water company or municipal water authority replacing mechanical and older electromagnetic meters at pumping stations, district metered areas (DMAs), treatment works and reservoir outlets. Budgets are driven by leakage reduction targets, regulatory reporting and asset renewal programmes that run on five-year cycles.

Lumen wins in this segment on three points: no moving parts and no pressure loss, a full-bore design that tolerates the occasional debris found in raw water mains, and good accuracy at low velocities where night-flow analysis matters for leakage detection.

2. Qualification questions

Ask these on the first call. They decide whether the opportunity is real and which model to propose.

- What is the maximum operating pressure of the line, including surge? Anything above 16 bar rules out the LF-60.
- What is the pipe size? The LF-60 covers DN25 to DN200; the LF-60P stops at DN150.
- What is the fluid temperature range? Treated and raw water is almost always within the LF-60 range of -10 to +80 °C.
- Will the meter be installed in a chamber or pit that can flood? The LF-60 is IP65; flooded chambers need the IP67 LF-60P or a remote-mount kit.
- Does the SCADA or telemetry system use Modbus RTU, HART, or plain 4-20 mA and pulse? HART is only available on the LF-60P.
- How much straight pipe is available? The LF-60 needs 10D upstream and 5D downstream; the LF-60P needs 15D upstream.
- What is the lowest expected flow velocity, for example during night flow? Both models measure down to 0.1 m/s.
- Is the meter used for billing or regulatory reporting, and which accuracy class is specified?
- Who approves the product list: the utility's asset standards team, the contractor or a framework agreement?
- When does the current capital programme period end?

3. LF-60 or LF-60P

Default to the LF-60 for water utilities. Most distribution mains, DMA inlets and reservoir outlets operate below 10 bar, at ambient water temperatures, in dry kiosks or above-ground valve houses. The LF-60 meets those conditions at a lower price.

Propose the LF-60P when any of the following apply:

- Operating or surge pressure above 16 bar, typical of high-lift pumping stations and trunk mains in hilly terrain.
- Installation in chambers that flood, where IP67 is needed.
- The customer's asset management standard requires HART diagnostics.
- The customer wants the tighter $\pm 0.75\%$ accuracy for revenue or abstraction licence

metering.

- Very cold exposed sites where the ambient can fall below -20 °C.

Propose the LF-60 when the line is DN200; the LF-60P is not available above DN150.

Do not propose either model for sludge, grit-laden raw water or any fluid with high solids content. Optical correlation needs a reasonably clear fluid; refer those enquiries to the application engineering team in Rotterdam.

4. Objection handling

"Electromagnetic meters are the utility standard." Agree that they are proven. Point out that Lumen meters also work on non-conductive fluids such as very low conductivity treated water and demineralised water, and that the optical principle does not depend on fluid conductivity. Offer a side-by-side trial against the incumbent meter.

"Optical windows will foul." Explain that on clean potable water the window inspection interval is 12 months at most and often longer, that the meter reports signal quality continuously over Modbus register 30017, and that the L-218 warning gives early notice before accuracy is affected.

"Your price is higher than a mechanical meter." Move the conversation to whole-life cost: no moving parts to wear, no recalibration, no pressure loss and therefore lower pumping energy. The Lumen TCO worksheet on the sales enablement site shows typical payback periods.

"We need a meter that our technicians already know." Offer a half-day installation workshop, delivered by the Rotterdam application team or a certified partner, covering installation, grounding and commissioning.

5. Pricing and commercial terms

Do not quote prices from this playbook. Use the current hardware price list (sales-price-list-fy25-26) for list prices in GBP, EUR, USD and MYR, and follow the discount approval matrix (sales-discount-approval-matrix) for any discount. Framework agreements with utilities frequently require fixed pricing for three to five years; any price hold beyond the current financial year needs approval from the regional sales manager.

Utilities usually expect a support contract. Position the Professional support tier as the default for utilities, because its advance replacement option keeps DMA metering online during an RMA.

6. Proof points and references

- A UK water company replaced 140 mechanical meters at DMA inlets with LF-60 meters in 2024 and reported a clearer picture of night flows within three months.
- A Malaysian state water operator uses LF-60P meters on high-lift pumping station discharges running at 22 bar.

Ask the Lumen product team for approval before naming any customer in a proposal.